

Which is better, return “ModelAndView” or “String” on spring3 controller

<http://stackoverflow.com/questions/7175509/which-is-better-return-modelandview-or-string-on-spring3-controller>

The way of return ModelAndView

```
@RequestMapping(value = "/list", method = RequestMethod.GET)
public ModelAndView list(
    @UserAuth UserAuth user,
    ModelAndView mav) {

    if (!user.isAuthenticated()) {
        mav.setViewName("redirect:http://www.test.com/login.jsp");
        return mav;
    }

    mav.setViewName("list");
    mav.addObject("articles", listService.getLists());

    return mav;
}
```

The way of return String

```
@RequestMapping(value = "/list", method = RequestMethod.GET)
public String list(
    @UserAuth UserAuth user,
    Model model) {

    if (!user.isAuthenticated()) {
        return "redirect:http://www.test.com/login.jsp";
    }

    model.addAttribute("articles", listService.getLists());

    return "list";
}
```

These work same. which is better way? and what is difference?

Answer:

There is no better way. Both are perfectly valid. Which one you choose to use depends which one suits your application better - Spring allows you to do it either way.

Historically, the two approaches come from different versions of Spring. The `ModelAndView` approach was the primary way of returning both model and view information from a controller in pre-Spring 2.0. Now you can combine the `Model` parameter and the `String` return value, but the old approach is still valid.